

HEART TALK

Victoria Memorial is getting a face-lift ...

The modernisation process has just begun. We have started repair and renovation, like cleaning of marbles both inside and outside. The galleries will get a sleek look.

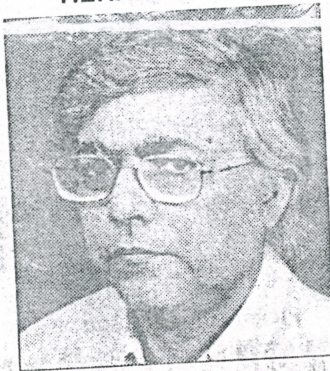
How are you going about it?

Paintings are being restored in collaboration with Calcutta Centenary Trust, London. Most paintings by the Daniell brothers, Zohan Zoffany and Tillykettle now have an enhanced effect because of the environment-friendly lights. The memorabilia of Queen Victoria are in perfect shape now. There is also reference material on the cultural history of each item.

How is the government helping?

The Government of India has sanctioned 10 technical posts to strengthen the conservation and preservation units. The lab has been modernised. A 25-member conservation centre will help

Chitta Panda, Curator, Victoria Memorial ON RENOVATING THE HERITAGE SITE



conserve artefacts in other institutes as well.

The Victoria Memorial gardens are like the lungs of the city. Are there any plans to make the greens even more pristine?

The garden and the ambience have improved significantly, thanks to the guidance of Governor Viren J Shah. Now the lawns look cleaner and greener. CPWD is entrusted with the work of repairing pavements. Aesthetically designed signboards will be installed soon.

How long will the renovation continue?

The first phase will take two years, and the second, hopefully, will not extend beyond three years. We have full support of the cultural ministry in this.

— Neelanjana Gautam